⌘ This manual is a starting point.
For the latest features, updates,
and deeper documentation,
refer to the online manual.

introduction

Spotykach was born of an admiration for early samplers and the artists who made beautiful music with them.
We had a simple goal: to make playing samples immediate, intuitive, and open to improvisation.

Spotykach has no screen–not because something is missing, but because something is preserved. In a world of glowing pixels, it invites you back to sound, touch, and time.
Learned through hands and ears like an acoustic instrument, sound and light respond instantly to every gesture, creating loops that keep you present, not lost in menus.

Designed as a looping playground, Spotykach lets you record, loop, sync (or not), slice, granulate, and discover the sound within your recordings. There is no correct outcome, only the pleasure of staying with the sound.

This is not about productivity. It is about presence.
Enjoy Spotykaching!

Roey & Vlad

modes of spotykach

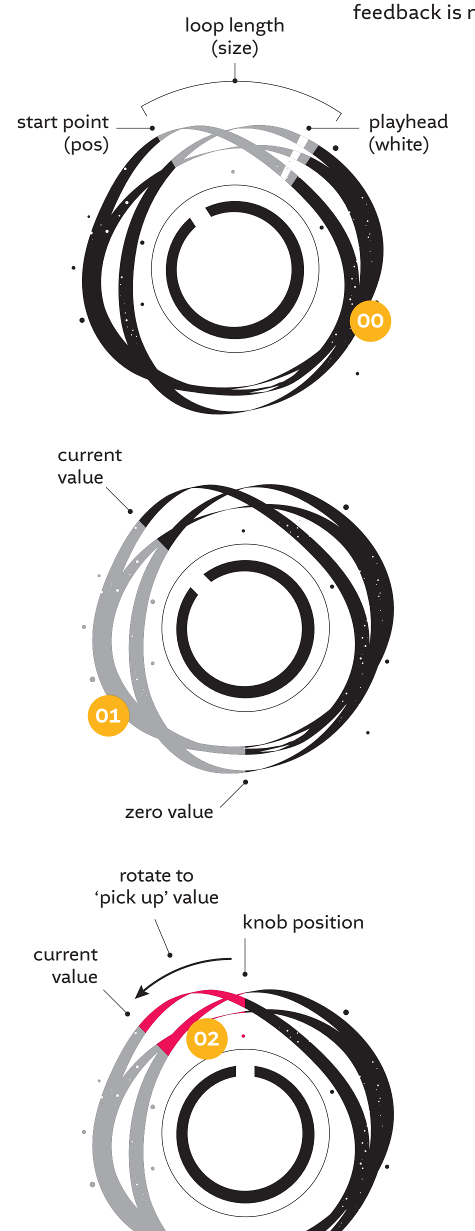
Spotykach decks can run in three different modes;
reel, slice and drift. Each mode is inspired by a different era of sampling, looping and performance techniques.

In the late 1940s, Pierre Schaeffer and others turned tape into an instrument, giving rise to musique concrète. Cutting, looping, and rearranging recorded sound reshaped how music could be made. With the advent of digital tools, sampling, looping, slicing and time-stretching became more accessible–while later granular and generative techniques opened entirely new musical territories.

Spotykach brings these eras together, allowing you to switch between modes instantly and explore sound as a living, playable system.

interacting with spotykach

Before we dive in, we'd like to introduce you to the philosophy behind our design language: Spotykach communicates through both light and sound. You don't just hear what's happening — you see it. Visual feedback is not decoration; it's an integral part of playing.



DECK BEHAVIOUR AND VISUALISATION

Spotykach has two identical decks with the same functionality, arranged in reverse layouts. In this manual, pads, knobs and patch points are referenced by number for easy navigation.

As soon as you start recording the **LED ring (00)** displays the buffer filling in real time. During playback, it shows the active buffer segment and the position of the playhead(s).

KNOB VALUE INDICATOR

When turning a knob, the **LED ring** displays its current value. Because some knobs control multiple parameters, the ring also reveals values that would otherwise remain hidden.

For example:

- Turn **deck A mix knob (03)**, the ring now represents deck A's mix position **(01)**.
- Hold **deck A Flux** pad on the top left of the unit **(31)** and turn the **mix knob** again. The ring now displays the **flux mix** value.
- If the physical knob position differs from the stored **flux mix** value, the offset is highlighted in red **(02)**. Turn the knob past this point to pick up the parameter and adjust it.

The **LED ring** reveals active and stored values at a glance, preventing jumps and making the instrument intuitive and responsive.

the decks

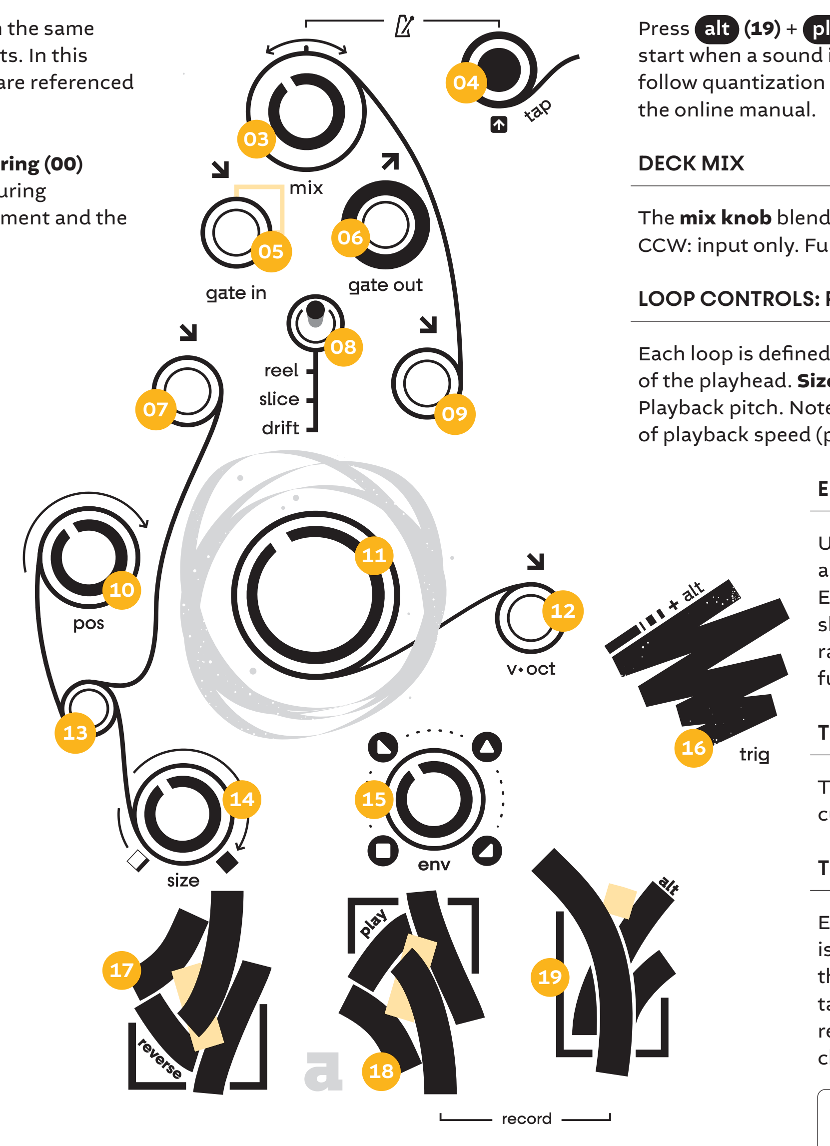
DECK MODES

Spotykach decks can operate in three modes: reel, slice, and drift. The selected mode determines how the recorded loop is captured, played back, and manipulated. Select a mode with the **mode switch (08)**. The deck's **LED ring** changes colour to indicate the active mode.

⌘ Discover additional Mode features & shortcuts in the online manual.

DETAIL FROM ONLINE MANUAL

Pressing (alt) + (reverse) will start recording from the opposing deck.



RECORDING & PLAYBACK

Press **alt** **(19)** + **play** **(18)** to arm. In **reel** and **drift** mode, recording will start when a sound is detected. In **slice** mode, recording and playback follow quantization settings. Learn more about launch quantization in the online manual.

DECK MIX

The **mix knob** blends the input signal **(21)** and the deck signal. Fully CCW: input only. Fully CW: deck only. The result is sent to the output **(22)**.

LOOP CONTROLS: POSITION, SIZE & PITCH

Each loop is defined by three core parameters: **Position (10)**: Start point of the playhead. **Size (14)**: Length of the active segment. **Pitch (11)**: Playback pitch. Note that in slice mode, pitch changes independently of playback speed (pitch shifting).

ENVELOPE

Use the **envelope knob (15)** to control the amplitude. When fully CCW the **envelope** is off. Engage the **envelope** by turning the knob CW, the shape will gradually morph towards a punchy ramp-down, followed by a ramp-up-ramp-down, fully CW the shape is ramp-up.

TRIG PAD

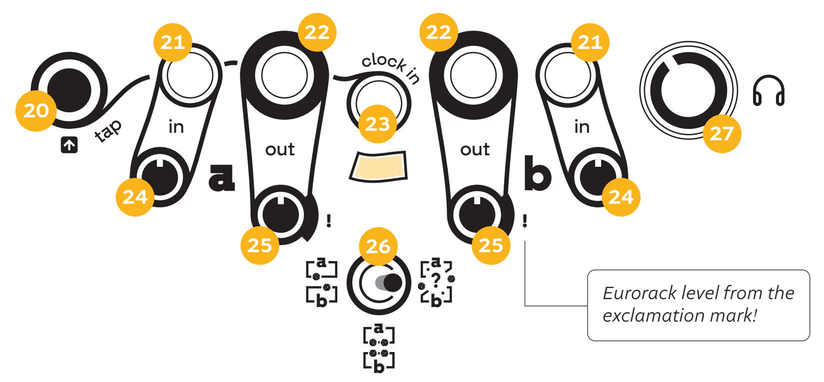
The **trig** pad **(16)** triggers the loop, using the current settings (size, position, pitch and envelope).

TRIGGER SEQUENCER

Each deck has a dedicated **trigger sequencer**, which is particularly useful in slice mode, but also works in the other modes. Tap **alt** **(19)** + **trig** **(16)** to arm, tap a rhythm on the **trig** pad. Tap **alt** to stop recording. Hold **alt** + **trig** for two seconds to clear the sequence.

Learn about the sequencer launch quantization behaviour in the online manual.

audio, routing & clock



INPUTS

Spotykach has two mono **inputs (21)**. Each **input** has a dedicated **gain trimmer (24)**. When nothing is plugged into input B, **input A** is normalled to **input B**.

OUTPUTS

Spotykach has two mono **outputs (22)** which can be routed in various ways (see **routing switch** chapter). Each **output** has a dedicated **gain trimmer (25)**. Note that the **output** gain can reach Eurorack levels 10Vpp, marked with an exclamation mark **(!)**.

It is good practice to start at low input and output levels to avoid damaging your (g)ear.

HEADPHONES

Spotykach has a dedicated **headphones output** on the back with a **volume knob (27)**.

ROUTING SWITCH (26)

Switch Left
Two mono decks. **Input A** is routed to **deck A**, **input B** is routed to **deck B.**

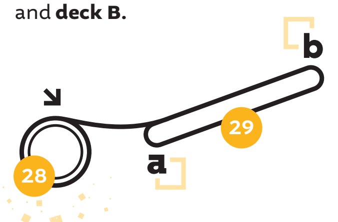
Switch Centre
Spotykach goes full stereo mode! Both input A and B are routed into both decks. **Input A** is panned hard left and **input B** is panned hard right. Output A and B function as left and right output.

Switch Right
Generative routing where **decks A and B** are panned randomly.

⌘ Routing differs between modes. See routing diagrams in the online manual.

MIX FADER

The **mix fader (29)** controls the blend between **deck A** and **deck B.**



CLOCK

Internal clock (green)
Set the **clock** speed by tapping the **tap** **(20)** button multiple times. **Clock** speed is indicated by the LED under **clock input (23)**.

External clock (pink)
Patch an external analog clock in **clock input (23)**. Tap **alt** + **tap** to switch to external clock.

In slice mode both playback and recording are synced to the clock. In reel and drift modes both playback and recording are unsynced. When the sequencer is engaged, clock drives playback in all modes.

LAUNCH QUANTIZATION

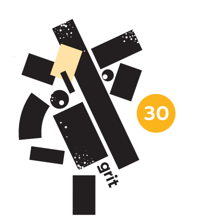
In **slice** mode, Spotykach can quantize recording and playback to various clock divisions.
Hold **tap** and turn **deck A mix knob (03)** to set the division.
The **LED ring** indicates the set quantization.

⌘ See quantization diagrams in the online manual

effects

Two effects are available at the end of each deck's signal chain on the **grit** **(30)** and **flux** **(31)** pads. Trigger the effects momentarily by tapping the corresponding pad, or latch them by tapping **alt** + **grit** / **flux**.

Hold grit / flux + tap to change their effects.



GRIT EFFECTS

Grit effects are texture-based, mixing saturation, filtering, distortion, bit crushing, and compression.

AMOUNT & MIX

To modify grit parameters, hold **grit** and turn the **pitch** and **mix** knobs.

Pitch (11)	sets the effect intensity
Mix (03)	sets the overall gain

⌘ Learn more about alternative effects in the online manual

FLUX EFFECTS

Flux effects are time-based, allowing you to apply delay, resonating feedback and stutter to the signal.

AMOUNT, MIX & TIME

To modify flux parameters, hold **flux** and turn the **pitch, mix** and **position** knobs.

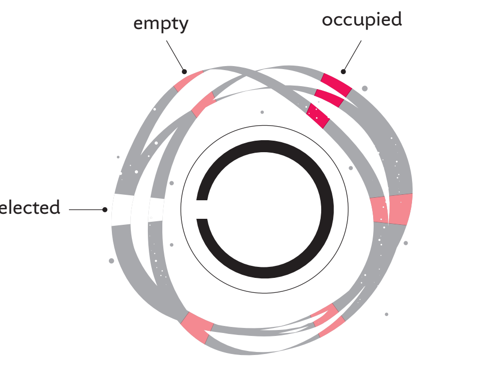
Pitch (11)	sets time
Mix (03)	sets dry/wet mix
Position (10)	sets feedback amount

Effects are applied non-destructively to both the incoming signal and the recorded material. This means you can use Spotykach as a real-time effects processor even without recording!

saving tracks

You can save recordings to the SD card. Each recording is a track; six tracks make one tape. Six color-coded tapes are available, allowing you to save and recall up to 36 tracks.

To enter or exit **tape mode** press **tap** **(20)** + **play** **(18)** of the deck you want to save from or recall to.
The **deck LED ring** will show the six track slots of the current tape; tap **trig** to swap tapes. An empty slot is indicated by a soft glow whereas an occupied slot glows brightly. Turn the knob to select a slot, tap **alt** + **play** to save, tap **alt** + **reverse** to recall.



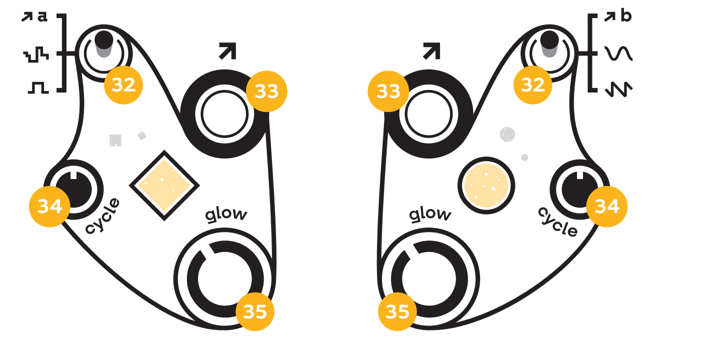
modulation

Spotykach comes to life through modulation. There are two internal modulation sources (going up to Eurorack level 0-5V) that can be patched into Spotykach or external gear.

SWITCH, CYCLE & GLOW

Select the modulation source by flipping the **modulation switch (32)**. Choose between envelope follower, and several LFO waveshapes.

Turn the **cycle trimmer (34)** to set the **LFO's speed**, and the **glow knob (35)** to attenuate the signal. The LED represents the outgoing signal.



ENVELOPE FOLLOWER

Each deck has an envelope follower, engage it by flipping the **modulation switch (32)** up.

The **cycle trimmer** controls the envelope speed, and the **glow knob** controls the amount.

Position and size can be modulated together or separate by flicking the switch (13) to either position.

MODULATION I/O

Spotykach has several **CV inputs** and **outputs**.

V/oct (12)	Pitch modulation
Mix (09)	Deck Mix modulation
Mix fader (28)	Deck A/B Mix modulation
Gate in (05)	Trigger the playhead
Pos/size (07)	Position and or size modulation following **switch (13)**
Mod out (33)	Modulation out (0-5V)
Gate out (06)	At the start of the loop (5V)

COLOPHON

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Spotykach is more than just hardware—it's an evolving open-source ecosystem. Visit our website to explore community-driven firmwares and unique add-ons.

Are you a developer? We'd love your input. You can contribute to the code on GitHub or brainstorm with us directly on the Synthux Discord server.

Firmware 1.0, 2026